Warm-up / A lunchtime choice

Make the tradeoff visible

Name: _____ Date: _____

Suggested lesson time: 30 minutes. Work individually, then compare when invited.

Useful words

Tradeoff: A gain in one respect accompanied by a cost or lost opportunity in another.

Opportunity cost: The benefit given up by using a limited resource for something else.

Read the scenario

Invented scenario: A class has a 40-minute lunch break. One proposal uses 10 minutes for quiet reading and leaves 30 minutes for eating and conversation. The current break allows all 40 minutes for eating and conversation.

Produce: Write one gain, one lost opportunity, and one group that could value that loss.

Your steps

1. Name the time gained for reading.
2. Name the time given up for another activity.
3. Identify students who could especially value the activity losing time.

Before you finish: Have you described both sides without assuming everyone has the same priority?

Your response

Main activity / How should study time be used?

Name: _____

Read the scenario

Invented scenario: A school has 60 minutes each week for optional study activities. It proposes moving 30 minutes from open reading to test preparation. Teachers expect more exam practice, but no evidence yet shows a score gain. Students who rely on school reading time would lose half that time.

Produce: Write a benefit, cost, and affected group; propose a feasible allocation; add one question to guide the decision.

Your steps

1. Make three labelled lines: possible benefit, cost, and affected group. Use the facts and distinguish an expected benefit from a demonstrated result.
2. Propose one alternative allocation of the 60 minutes and explain its tradeoff.
3. Write one question the school should answer before choosing a plan.

Before you finish: Do all allocations total 60 minutes? Have you named who bears the cost rather than calling the proposal simply 'good' or 'bad'?

Your response

Exit ticket / Sharing the community room

Name: _____

Read the scenario

Invented scenario: A community center has six evening room-hours to allocate each week. It currently offers six hours of homework help. A proposal would use two hours for art and four for homework help. Some students have no quiet study space at home. No results for the art program are available.

Produce: Write a benefit, cost, and affected group; recommend a six-hour allocation with a reason; ask one useful question.

Your steps

1. Identify a possible gain from art and the loss from reducing homework help, including who may be affected.
2. Choose hours for art and homework help totaling six, and explain your priority and its cost.
3. Name one question about outcomes or needs that could change your recommendation.

Before you finish: Does your allocation total six, and have you acknowledged the cost of your preferred option?

Your response